shaped and strengthened European coloniality, which, in turn, reflected in the political structure established in the colonies. Therefore, it should come as no surprise that the ideas and values of these milestones formed the basis of the constitutions introduced in the colonies by the coloniser. Among them, the most cardinal is the conception of colonised societies as nation-states—the *grundnorm* of Western political organisation.

When European nation-states emerged following the Peace of Westphalia, they were still a part of Christian Europe, with the three Christian denominations vying for the status of the true religion. Therefore, notwithstanding the internal fissures, conversations and debates, they were united in their stated goal of the expansion of the boundaries of Christianity through conquest of the New World. In other words, Christian nation-states were acutely alive to the religious-territorial canvas they were located within, which means that their nation-statehood was Christian in nature with a clear focus on demarcating their respective territories *within* Christian Europe. To impute secular nation-statehood to such States reflects wishful thinking on the part of those that view history with rose-tinted glasses.

In stark contrast to the ‘Christian secular’ character of European nation-states, the secularised model of nation-statehood that was exported to the colonies required the natives to abandon their consciousness and start on a clean slate on the assumption that their identities began only with the arrival of the coloniser to whom the only acceptable form of political organisation was that of a nation-state. As a consequence, most colonies embraced nationalism of the territorial kind, which altered their priorities significantly. The deprivation of a cultural or civilisational anchor to their ‘modern’ identities meant that their visions of the past, present and future were limited to merely preserving territorial integrity while constantly ceding space on civilisational integrity to coloniality. Thenceforth, civilisational consciousness and integrity would be the exclusive preserve of Western imperialism, while the rest of the world was expected to abandon its roots, reduced to a mere source of primary data for the West to analyse, thereby handing them the power to theorise and formulate abstract universals even after decolonisation.

Along with the internalisation of nation-statehood, concepts, such as separation of the Church and the State (‘secularism’), separation of powers, ‘toleration’, ‘liberty’ and notions of rights and duties, were secularised with